

GALACTUS

Devourer of Worlds

GALACTUS

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Galen

OCCUPATION

Consumer of planets

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

26 ft 9 in

WEIGHT

18.2 tons

EYES

Unknown; to humanoids appear white

HAIR

Unknown; appears black to humanoids

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four #48

(March 1966)

POWERS

Manipulates vast cosmic power; can restructure matter and deliver a planet-shattering energy blast; able to teleport across the galaxy and create force fields; travels the galaxy in a warship the size of the solar system; also pilots a smaller, circular "shuttle."



In the last universe's final moments, Galactus awaited his death.

Older than the universe itself, the only survivor of the universe that came before our own, Galactus's fate is inextricably bound up with that of the entire cosmos. Although at times he has been a force for good, far more often he has brought doom, destroying whole peoples and consuming entire worlds, for his hunger for energy is insatiable; without it, he would cease to exist.

GALEN OF TAA

Born Galen, on the paradise world of Taa, Galactus was fated to live in the last days of his universe, just as it was entering the final stages of the Big Crunch. Realizing that his people were doomed, he persuaded them to pilot a vessel into the heart of the Crunch, to die in one last act of heroism. His people perished, but Galactus was somehow saved by the Phoenix Force of his universe.

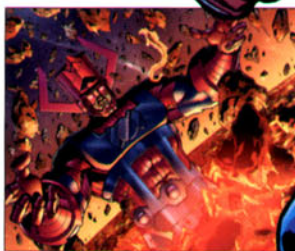
For billions of years he slept, and when he awoke it was with an immense hunger that could only be sated by consuming the life-energies of a world. At first he searched for uninhabited worlds but his hunger gradually forced him to consume planets populated by sentient races. Galactus's conscience was only eased by a prophecy that he would ultimately make good on the devastation he wrought.

GALACTUS'S HERALD

During a search for food, Galactus came upon the planet Zenn-La. To save his homeworld, Norrin Radd agreed to become Galactus's herald and to search out new planetary fodder. Transformed into the SILVER SURFER, Radd's emotions were subdued so he would be willing to identify inhabited worlds for Galactus. However the Surfer's conscience was

reawakened when Galactus turned his attentions to Earth. With the FANTASTIC FOUR, the Surfer drove his master away.

At one point, Galactus was killed, but he was later resurrected to help prevent Abraxas from destroying the entire multiverse. Recently, Galactus was held in the galactic prison Klyn, but DRAX THE DESTROYER broke him out so that he could stop the Annihilation Wave (see pp. 30-1). AD, MF



As the centuries passed, countless worlds crumbled before Galactus's devouring might.



A being of immense power and size, only the very brave or foolish would stand against Galactus.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Fantastic Four #48-50

Galactus discovers the Earth and, for the very first time in his immortal life, experiences defeat.

• Silver Surfer Vol. 1 #1

Galactus's first meeting with Norrin Radd, soon to become the Silver Surfer, is detailed.

• Galactus the Devourer #1-6

Galactus is seemingly destroyed by the combined efforts of the Avengers, Fantastic Four, and the Shi'ar Empire.

GAEA

FIRST APPEARANCE Doctor Strange #6 (February 1975)

REAL NAME Gaea OCCUPATION Goddess BASE Earth

WEIGHT Variable EYES Blue HAIR Black

POWERS/ABILITIES Possesses enormous mystical

powers; tied to the Earth; commands the forces of nature, such as

and volcanic activity; power to heal and make things grow;

abilities; able to bestow magical powers.



Gaea is the embodiment of the spirit of life, growth, harvest and renewal on Earth. One of the foremost of the Elder Gods who ruled the world when mankind was not yet a glimmer, Gaea was the only one not to devolve into a demon, feeding on the spirits of others to survive. Instead, she became literally Mother Earth, and oversaw the growth of all living things. With Odin (see GODS OF ASGARD), Gaea conceived THOR, who is both of Asgard and of Earth, and the champion of both realms. TB

◉ GALACTUS see opposite page

GAMORA

FIRST APPEARANCE Strange Tales Vol. 1 #180 (June 1975)

REAL NAME Gamora

OCCUPATION Former assassin; member of the Infinity Watch

BASE Mobile

HEIGHT 6 ft WEIGHT 170 lbs EYES Green HAIR Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Expert gymnast and martial artist; proficient with all known weapons.



Gamora is the sole survivor of the Zen-Whoberi, an alien race wiped out by MAGUS and his Universal Church of Truth. The mad Titan THANOS rescued Gamora as an infant and trained her to become the deadliest assassin in the galaxy. Thanos killed her after a failed rebellion, and Adam WARLOCK absorbed her spirit into his soul-gem. She returned in a new form, and guarded the Time Gem as a member of the Infinity Watch. DW

GAMBIT

The mutant Gambit was abducted soon after his birth by members of the Thieves' Guild of New Orleans. Hoping to make peace between the Thieves' Guild and their rivals, the Assassins' Guild, Remy married the granddaughter of the Assassins' Guild's leader. Her brother Julien was opposed to the union, and Remy killed him in a duel. Banished from New Orleans, Remy became the international master thief known as Gambit. Gambit was employed by SINISTER to organize the MARAUDERS, a mutant team of assassins, but he was shocked when Sinister sent the Marauders to massacre the MORLOCKS.

Later, Gambit met and aided STORM, who had been turned into a child at the time. Storm later sponsored Gambit's membership in the X-Men. He has had a longstanding love affair with his X-Men teammate ROGUE. Gambit later served as one of Apocalypse's Horsemen—Death—and even rejoined the Marauders. He helped save the first mutant baby born after M-Day and has currently rejoined the X-Men to help find Rogue. PS, MF



More fiery fallings-out as Rogue gives Gambit a taste of his own medicine—an energy blast that knocks him off his feet.



Gambit and Rogue's relationship had its explosive side: here, she nimbly avoids Gambit's "energy charge card."



GARDENER

FIRST APPEARANCE Marvel Team-Up #55 (March 1977)

REAL NAME Ord Zoryn

OCCUPATION Botanist BASE The known universe

HEIGHT 7 ft 1 in WEIGHT 390 lbs EYES Purple HAIR Gray

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Almost immortal, but not quite; Soul-Gem worn on forehead enables travel between worlds and to other dimensions; Soul-Gem also accelerates growth of plants.

One of the ELDERS OF THE UNIVERSE, the Gardener belonged to one of the first sentient species to roam the cosmos. Dedicating his life to horticulture, the Gardener spent his days collecting new seeds and cultivating barren worlds. The Gardener's fate was bound up with the two Soul-Gems that he used to travel between worlds and to accelerate plant growth. Abandoning the first Soul-Gem after using it in battle with the STRANGER, the Gardener fought the DEATH-worshipping ETERNAL THANOS to retain his second gem, but the battle resulted in his death. AD



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Remy LeBeau

OCCUPATION

Professional thief, adventurer

BASE

New Orleans, Louisiana; the Xavier Institute, Salem Center, New York State

HEIGHT

6 ft 1 in

WEIGHT

175 lbs

EYES

Black (red pupils)

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

The Uncanny X-Men #266

(August 1990)

Mutant ability to charge small objects with an unknown form of energy; when he throws the objects at a target, they explode on impact

GAMBIT

POWERS